Track recruiting calendar, Class of 2029

Class of 2029 · built from rules read 2026-11-05 · written 2026-11-06 · playbook id w10-track

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises an offer, aid, a roster spot or a time. We do not contact coaches or your athlete. **RULE** = a bylaw we cite. **PROJECTED** = calculated, not yet published. **RECOMMENDED / YOUR PLAN** = our suggestion, not an NCAA deadline. Confirm every date with each school's compliance office.

Part A.The picture in one page

What opens	Class of 2029 date	Source
D1 calls, texts, emails	RULE 2027-06-15 (after sophomore year)	[S1 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1]
D1 off-campus contact	RULE 2027-06-15 (changed 2026-10-07; older guides say August 1)	[S1 13.1.1.1.9]
D1 official visits and athletics-involved unofficial visits	RULE 2027-08-01	[S1 13.6.2.1.1, 13.7.1.1]
Recruiting talk at a D1 camp	RULE 2027-08-01	[S1 13.12.1.5.1]
D3 official visits	RULE 2028-01-01	[S3 13.6.1.1.1]
Written aid offer (D1)	RULE 2028-08-01	[S1 13.9.3.1]
Signing opens (D1)	PROJECTED 2028-11-08	[S1 13.02.13.1(f)]
NAIA	no recruiting calendar and no limit on communication	[S15]

Before a date opens. A family may write a coach, fill a questionnaire or attend a camp at any time; the dates limit what the coach may send or say [S26; S19]. Silence before the date is the rule, not a "no."

Academic lines (D1). 10 of 16 core courses finished, 7 in English, math or science, before the seventh semester [S1 14.3.1.1(b)]. 16 cores, 2.300 core GPA, graduate, final transcript [S1 14.3.1.1(a)]. D2 asks 2.2 [S7]. D3: school sets its bar [S7]. NAIA: separate center; a freshman is eligible with 2.3+ GPA, or two of three: 18 ACT / 970 SAT, 2.0 GPA, top half of class [S13; S14].

Roster reality. D1 settlement schools: cross country 17 per gender, indoor and outdoor track 45 per gender [S9]. A cap is a ceiling, not open spots [S8]. D2 limit: 12.6 equivalencies for track and cross country combined [S11]. D3 gives no athletic aid [S7].

What programs publish. Track is the one sport of the three where programs publish numbers. The spread is large and labels differ (target, scholarship consideration, walk-on consideration), so lines from different programs are not like-for-like and levels overlap. Examples as published (men's 400m): Rutgers "consider for full aid" 46.20 [S22]; Eastern Michigan scholarship 47.50 [S24]; Brown walk-on consideration 48.70 [S21]; Oral Roberts target 49.6 [S23]; MIT D3 recruiting line 50.50 [S25]. Programs say the number is not the decision: Oral Roberts states that achieving the marks does not guarantee a scholarship or roster spot [S23]; Rutgers lists academics, team need and consistency at standard [S22]. Use the program's own PDF for your event, same label to same label. Third-party "D1 top / D1 low" tables are vendor composites, not program standards [W7-recruitiq 1C].

Context, not odds. About 5.4% of high school track athletes appear on an NCAA roster in the same year (1.9% D1, 1.5% D2, 2.0% D3). A ratio of two headcounts for 2024-25, leaving out NAIA and JUCO; not your athlete's chance [S17].

Dated calendar (each row cites its bylaw)

2026-11-15 **Recommended (not NCAA)**

Have the counselor check every course against the NCAA list

Map completed and planned classes against your school's NCAA-approved course list. Not every class counts. This is our recommended date, not an NCAA one.

If missed: Problems found in 12th grade are often too late to fix.

D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-06-15 **Opens**

Calls, messages and off-campus contact open together

Changed October 7, 2026: track and cross country off-campus contact now opens June 15 after sophomore year, the same day as calls and texts. Older guides still say August 1.

If missed: None for starting later.

D1 Bylaws 13.1.1.1.9, 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-08-01 **Opens**

Official and unofficial visits may begin

August 1 of junior year for official visits and unofficial visits involving the athletics department.

If missed: Visiting too early is a violation.

D1 Bylaws 13.6.2.1.1, 13.7.1.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2027-08-15 **Recommended (not NCAA)**

Open the NCAA Eligibility Center certification account

D1 and D2 recruits need a certification account ($110 domestic, fee waivers possible) before any D1 official visit. The free Profile Page isn't enough. Recommended date, not an NCAA deadline.

If missed: Without it, a school can't host you on an official visit.

D1 Bylaw 13.6.3 · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/Registration_Checklist.pdf

2028-08-01 **Opens**

Written scholarship offers may arrive

A written athletics aid offer can't come before August 1 of senior year.

If missed: None. Compare any offer against the full net price.

D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.1 · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

HARD DEADLINE

Finish 10 of your 16 core courses before senior year

Division I requires 10 NCAA-approved core courses, 7 of them English, math or science, finished before the first day of the seventh semester. Those grades lock. Your school sets the exact date.

If missed: Can block qualifier status and first-year competition. Senior-year courses can't repair it.

D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2028-11-08 ***PROJECTED (not yet published)***

Projected signing opens

Second Wednesday in November, calculated from current rules. Not yet published.

If missed: No penalty for signing later.

D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(f) · https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2029-04-01 **Window**

Final amateurism certification request opens

Fall 2029 enrollees can request final amateurism certification in their Eligibility Center account from April 1. It's when the window opens, not a cutoff.

If missed: Not an automatic loss, but waiting can delay clearance to compete.

Eligibility Center procedure · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/How_to_Request_Final_Amateurism_Certification.pdf

HARD DEADLINE

Graduate and get final certification

Finish all 16 core courses with at least a 2.3 core GPA, graduate, and have the school send the final transcript to the Eligibility Center. A transcript GPA isn't the same as a core GPA.

If missed: Can delay or block first-year competition. A verbal commitment isn't clearance.

D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.3 · https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/IE_Brochure.pdf

The stages at a glance

Stage 0. Home base (one evening, before 2027-06-15)
Done when: folder exists, Sunday slot is on both calendars, C1 has a dollar figure.

Stage 1. Lock the academics (now; recheck each semester)
Done when: C4 shows 10/7 reachable and the account number is in the folder. If not, book the counselor this week and ask in writing for the course plan that gets there.

Stage 2. Make every mark verifiable (spring 2027, YOUR PLAN)
Done when: every mark in C5 has a link that opens for a stranger.

Stage 3. Target list from published marks (before 2027-06-15)
Done when: C2 has 30 rows, each with a published line or "no published standard," and the date you read it.

Stage 4. First contact (RULE 2027-06-15)
Done when: 20 messages logged, no reply unanswered, no follow-up more than 3 days overdue.

Stage 5. Meets, camps, visits (2027-08-01 onward)
Done when: every camp has a C8 row, spend is under C1, every visit has a C9 score within 24 hours.

Stage 6. Offers, comparison, signing (2028-08-01 onward)
Done when: C10 has no blank cell for the offer being accepted, and athlete and parent chose together.

Sources used: S1, S3, S4, S5, S7, S8, S9, S11, S13, S14, S15, S17, S19, S21, S22, S23, S24, S25, S26, S35, S38, S40. Table: `../shared/SOURCES.md`. Full source table is in the Commit Book. Education, not legal advice. Rules change; check the cited source and each school's compliance office before acting. The Recruiting Calendar.